

Mengfei Li

PhD Candidate in Management Science
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AI-based Empirical Operations Management

Education

Fudan University, School of Management

PhD Candidate, Management Science

- Department of Management Science. Advisor: Prof. Xiaole Wu.

Shanghai, China

Sep. 2022 – Present

Operations & Decision Technologies, Kelley School of Business, Indiana University

Visiting PhD Student

- Host: Prof. Wenchang Zhang.

Bloomington, IN, USA

Sep. 2024 – Dec. 2024

Fudan University, School of Management

B.S. in Statistics

- Department of Statistics. Advisor: Prof. Feiyu Jiang.

Shanghai, China

Sep. 2018 – Jun. 2022

Research Interests

AI-based Empirical Operations Management.

Publications and Manuscripts

- Distribution Shift Alignment Helps LLMs Simulate Survey Response Distributions.** Ji Huang, **Mengfei Li**, Shuai Shao (listed in alphabetical order). *ACL 2026 Findings* (CCF-A).
- Experience-Based Learning in SMEs: A Dual Perspective on Manufacturing Efficiency and Consistency.** **Mengfei Li**, Wenchang Zhang, Cheng Yue, Ming Liu, Xiaole Wu. Revise and resubmit at *Management Science*.
- Metrics of Supply Chain Resilience: Structural Change-Points and Weighted Cumulative Loss.** **Mengfei Li**, Xiaole Wu, Yang Chen, Jinyan Zhu. Third-round review at *Journal of Management Sciences in China*.
- A Structural Forest Estimation of Heterogeneous Newsvendor Models.** **Mengfei Li**, Guihua Wang, Wenchang Zhang. Working paper.
- LLMs Simulate Survey Response for Joint Distribution of Multiple Questions.** Ji Huang, **Mengfei Li**, Shuai Shao (listed in alphabetical order). Working paper.
- A Counterfactual Analysis of Capacity Decision of Photovoltaic Enterprises.** Ziyin Bin, **Mengfei Li**, Zibo Liu, Lezhen Wu, Xiaole Wu (listed in alphabetical order). Working paper.
- Little-Treat Consumption: A Qualitative Analysis Using Generative Large Language Models (GLLMs).** Zhe Zhang, Handan Shi, **Mengfei Li**. Working paper.

Conference Presentations

- Dissecting the Learning Curve for Supply Chain Efficiency: An Empirical Analysis.** 14th POMS-HK International Conference, Hong Kong, Jan. 2024; 16th CSAMSE Conference, Xiamen, Jul. 2024; 2024 INFORMS Annual Meeting, Seattle, Oct. 2024; 2024 DSI Annual Conference, Phoenix, Nov. 2024; 15th POMS-HK International Conference, Hong Kong, Jan. 2025; Workshop on Empirical Operations Management, Hong Kong, Jan. 2025 (presentation by the supervisor); 35th POMS Annual Conference, Atlanta, May 2025.
- A Structural Forest Estimation of Heterogeneous Newsvendor Models.** 35th POMS Annual Conference, Atlanta, May 2025; 2025 INFORMS International Meeting, Singapore, Jul. 2025.

Research Projects

- Jan. 2023 – Dec. 2027.** Participant, National Natural Science Foundation of China Major Project, “供应链韧性与安全基础理论” (Theoretical Foundations of Supply Chain Resilience and Security).
- Jan. 2025 – Dec. 2027.** Principal Investigator, National Natural Science Foundation of China Young Student Basic Research Project (Doctoral Students), “因果机器学习与结构模型估计的结合理论研究与应用” (Integrating Causal Machine Learning and Structural

Model Estimation: Theory and Optimization Applications).

- **Feb. 2025 – Present.** Participant, State Grid Shanghai Electric Power Company Management Consulting Project, “基于 SPOT 框架的电网供应链网络韧性与安全分析” (Power Grid Supply Chain Network Resilience and Security Analysis Based on the SPOT Framework).
- **Dec. 2025 – Dec. 2026.** Participant, China Energy Research Society Research Consulting Project, “光伏行业四层级结构模型构建服务项目” (Four-tier Structural Model Construction Service Project for the Photovoltaic Industry).

Academic Service

- Anonymous Reviewer, *Journal of Asian Economics*.

Books, Data Resources, and Software

- Participant, National Development and Intelligent Governance Laboratory Basic Research and Visualization Platform, Fudan University.
- Participant, China Foreign Merchandise Trade and Supply Chain Volatility Index, Fudan University Global Supply Chain Research Center.
- Contributor, *Operations Management in the Digital Era* (tentative title), edited by Xiaole Wu et al.
- Creator and maintainer, R package **SFHNV**.

Honors & Awards

- **2025.** Outstanding Student Model, Fudan University (10 students per year).
- **2025.** Honorable Mention, 15th POMS-HK International Conference Best Student Paper Award (6 students per year).
- **2019–2021.** Cargill Global Scholar, Cargill (15 students per year).
- **2019–2020.** Huawei Scholarship / First-Class Outstanding Student Scholarship, Fudan University.
- **2022–2027.** Zhuobo Scholarship, Fudan University.
- **2020–2021.** Zheng Zukang Academic Scholarship, Fudan University.
- **2018–2019, 2020–2021, 2021–2022.** Outstanding Student, Fudan University.

Teaching Experience

- Teaching Assistant, MBA Course: Science and Technology Innovation Young Cadre Program, Fudan University.
- Teaching Assistant, Undergraduate Course: Operations Management, Fudan University.